

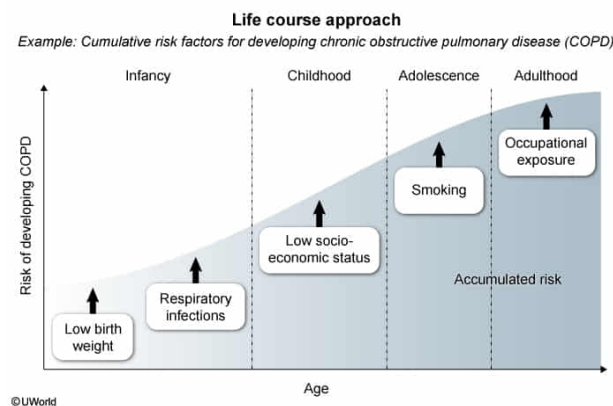
Researchers have identified a set of factors associated with an increased risk of developing chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, including low birth weight, respiratory infections before age 2, low socioeconomic status in childhood, adolescent smoking, and occupational exposure to airborne irritants as an adult. This finding best reflects:

- ☐ A. the sick role theory approach. [2%]
- ☐ B. the illness experience perspective. [4%]
- ☐ C. the social construction of chronic disease. [30%]
- ✓ ☒ D. the life course approach to illness. [62%]

Correct

63% answered correctly

Explanation:



The **life course approach** is a holistic, multidisciplinary framework for understanding how psychological, biological, and sociocultural factors **across a lifetime** have a **cumulative effect** on health outcomes. This perspective considers how personal life events (eg, illness in infancy), individual choices/behaviors (eg, having unprotected sex), and sociocultural and historical context (eg, being born during wartime) impact health and illness.

Research suggesting that lifetime exposure to biological (eg, respiratory infections), sociocultural (eg, low socioeconomic status), and behavioral (eg, smoking) risk factors increases the likelihood of developing chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD) is most reflective of the *life course approach to illness*.

(Choice A) Sick role theory is a functionalist approach describing how disruption to typical social activity (eg, work) caused by illness is minimized through the sick role, which legitimizes illness as socially acceptable deviance. Biological and sociocultural factors impacting health/illness across a lifetime are not relevant to sick role theory.

(Choice B) The illness experience is a symbolic interactionist approach to understanding how people incorporate and make sense of illness as part of their self-identity and daily routines. The illness experience is not best reflected by evidence that biological and sociocultural factors impact health/illness across a lifetime.

(Choice C) Social constructionism suggests that social reality is created through interpersonal interactions, which result in shared meanings and expected roles/behaviors. The social construction of chronic illness would not be concerned with the cumulative impact of factors across a lifetime contributing to risk of chronic illness.

Educational objective:

The life course approach to illness is holistic and multidisciplinary, examining the cumulative effect of psychological, biological, and sociocultural factors across a lifetime on health outcomes.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401763

System:
Demographics and Social Structure